London Borough of Camden
Information and Records Management
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Date: 12/01/2024
Case reference: CAM6704

Dear Requester

Thank you for your request for information dated 19/12/2023 about **pivigo dealing with rent arrears, algorithms for 'model drift' and rent-prediction or rent-gathering**. We have dealt with this under the Freedom of Information Act 2000.

Response

The council holds the information requested and the answers to your questions are as follows:

The requests are:

Request 1

Hello, hope you're well. I'm looking into the use of artificial intelligence and rent payments, and saw that Camden council was working with Pivigo to deal with the problem of rental arrears.

I was hoping you might be able to give me some context on how successful this has been?

According to documentation, it also says that Camden council has been testing the algorithm for 'model drift' on a monthly basis. I was hoping you might be able to provide me with the results of such testing?

We do not hold this information. This is because the engagement with Pivigo did not proceed beyond the pilot/testing phase. As the service was never incorporated into live operational use, we did not reach the stage of testing the algorithm for model drift.

Request 2

According to documentation, it also says that Camden council has been testing Pivigo's algorithm for 'model drift' on a monthly basis.

I am requesting documents on the results of such testing over the past 12 months.

Please see the response above.

Request 3

I'm requesting information on any rent-prediction or rent-gathering algorithms used by the council. Please provide me a list of tools, either in-house or through a third-party agent, the council uses to:

- *Analyse the cost of housing in the area*
- *Predict a tenant's ability to pay rent*
- *Facilitate a tenant paying their rent*

I would also like a copy of the most recent risk assessment of any algorithms that are used.

There are not currently any rent-prediction or rent-gathering algorithms in use at the Council and we are constantly reviewing our systems and approach.

Further Information:

We do not give our consent for any names and contact details provided in this response to be sent marketing material. Any such use will be reported to the ICO as a breach of General Data Protection Regulations and the Privacy and Electronic Communication Regulations.

Why not check our Portal Open Data Camden before making a new request as your question may already be answered by a previous FOI response or in one of our many useful and interesting datasets.

Your Rights

If you are not happy with how your response was handled you can request an Internal Review within 2 months of this letter by email to foireviews@camden.gov.uk or post: Information and Records Management Team, London Borough of Camden, Town Hall, Judd Street, London WC1H 9JE. Please quote your case reference number. If you are not satisfied with the Internal Review outcome you can complain to the Information Commissioner's Office at icocasework@ico.org.uk, Telephone: 0303 123 1113, live chat https://ico.org.uk/global/contact-us/live-chat/ or webform https://ico.org.uk/global/contact-us/. The ICO website https://www.ico.org.uk may be useful.

Yours sincerely,

Peter Williams
Information Rights Officer